

the left, then on the gear icon (settings), followed by the little globe icon. This should bring up the URL, which you can feed into a CardDAV client to access and sync your contacts to the server. This URL is what you can use to access your contacts.

Add-ons and extensions

Apart from this, multiple tools and add-ons can be used along with desktop clients such as Thunderbird to make syncing your contacts easy as pie. A notable extension to Thunderbird in this area is 'gContactSync', which you can either search for in the Add-ons manager built into Thunderbird or download from: <http://dgit.in/gContactSync>. Though Outlook doesn't allow contacts to be synced with Google, a tool named 'Contacts Sync' (<http://dgit.in/ContactsSync>) promises to bring in the ability to do so. If you use Google Apps for Business with Outlook, a tool has been made available by Google itself, which you can download from: <http://dgit.in/GAppsSync>.



gContactsSync at work

That was about syncing contacts. If you want to back them up, almost all clients and service providers will give you an option to download the contacts in a format compatible to your system (in most cases, you get a VCF format file which can be shared with others as well).

Sync your calendars

Being popular has its advantages. Say, if you're trying to sync calendar services belonging to Google, Yahoo, Apple or Microsoft Exchange service over multiple devices, it's quite easy to do since most devices support them.

Just as the CardDAV protocol is used to share contacts info, the CalDAV protocol is used to share calendars. Here, however, we have a mix of different standards and different ways to achieve this. If you simply want to